

Document	IT-01 IT Acceptable Use & Security
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IT Acceptable Use & Security

1. Purpose and scope

Our planning system, customer records and email are what keep the trucks moving. If they are lost, locked or leaked, deliveries stop and customers lose trust in us. This policy explains how to use company IT safely and what to do quickly when something goes wrong. Most of it comes down to three habits: protect your sign-in, report problems at once, and keep customer data inside company systems.

1.1 Who this applies to

This policy applies to everyone who uses Tallowby Freight IT, including laptops, desktop PCs, mobile phones, drivers' handhelds, email, the planning system and StaffPoint. It also applies to agency staff and contractors who are given an account, and to personal devices used to access company email or files.

1.2 Monitoring

Company systems are logged to keep them secure. The IT team can see which devices sign in, from where and when, and which files are shared outside the company. We do not read the content of individual email or chat messages unless there is a specific security incident or a formal investigation approved by the Head of People and the Head of IT.

2. Passwords and sign-in

2.1 Passwords

Your company password must be at least 14 characters long. The easiest way to reach that is a passphrase of three or four unrelated words. Do not use your company password for any other site, and never share it with anyone, including colleagues or IT staff. The IT team will never ask for your password. You only need to change your password if there is a reason to think someone else knows it. Every employee can use the company password manager to store passwords for other work sites.

2.2 Multi-factor authentication

Multi-factor authentication (MFA) is switched on for email, StaffPoint, the planning system and anything you can reach from outside our sites. You approve sign-ins with the authenticator app, which you can install on a company phone or on your own phone. If you do not want the app on your own phone, the IT Service Desk will give you a small hardware security key instead. Never approve a sign-in request that you did not start yourself; report it to the IT Service Desk straight away.

2.3 Locking your screen

Lock your computer every time you walk away from it, even for a minute. Screens lock automatically after 5 minutes without use. After 5 wrong password attempts your account is locked for 15 minutes; if you need it sooner, call the IT Service Desk.

3. Lost or stolen devices

3.1 Report it straight away

If a company laptop, phone, tablet, handheld or security key is lost or stolen, report it to the IT Service Desk on ext. 300 or at itsupport@tallowby.example within 1 hour of noticing it is missing. The same applies to a personal phone that has company email on it. Reporting quickly matters more than anything else: we can lock and wipe the device remotely, but only if we know. You will not be in trouble for reporting a loss, even if it turns out the device was only mislaid.

3.2 Out of hours

The IT Service Desk is staffed from 07:00 to 19:00, Monday to Friday. Outside those hours, phone the Transport Planning Office on ext. 100, which is staffed 24 hours a day. They will contact the on-call IT engineer, who will lock the device and your account. Do not wait until the next working day.

3.3 Theft and police reports

If a device has been stolen, report the theft to the police and send the crime reference number to itsupport@tallowby.example within 24 hours. A replacement device is normally ready the next working day. Drivers can collect a spare handheld from the depot office so that deliveries are not delayed.

4. Personal devices

4.1 Work email and chat on your own phone

You may read work email and use work chat on your own phone, but only through the approved work profile set up by the IT Service Desk. The work profile keeps company data separate from your own photos and apps. If the phone is lost, we wipe only the work profile and never your personal data. Company data must not be copied from the work profile into personal apps.

4.2 Personal laptops and home computers

Do not store company files on a personal laptop or home computer, and do not forward work email to a personal email account. If you need to work from home, use a company laptop, as set out in HR-05. When you work on any network outside our sites, including hotel, café and home Wi-Fi, connect to the company VPN before opening company systems.

4.3 Wi-Fi at our sites

The operational Wi-Fi at our depots is for company devices only, including handhelds and scanners. Personal phones and visitors' devices must use the guest Wi-Fi, which has no access to company systems.

5. AI tools and customer data

5.1 Approved AI tools

You may use the company's approved AI assistant, which is available to all office staff through their company account. Data entered into it stays within our business account and is not used to train anyone else's models. The current list of approved AI tools is kept on the IT page of the intranet. Any tool that is not on that list is not approved, however useful it looks.

5.2 What you must never upload

Never paste, type or upload any of the following into a public or unapproved AI tool, chatbot, translation website or browser extension:

- customer names, contacts or delivery addresses;
- consignment details, delivery notes or proof of delivery documents;
- our rates, quotes or contract terms;
- personal information about colleagues, drivers or job applicants;
- passwords, system screenshots or internal reports.

If you have already uploaded something from this list by mistake, report it to the IT Service Desk on the same day. The Data Protection Lead will decide whether anyone needs to be told.

5.3 Checking what AI produces

AI tools can be confidently wrong. You are responsible for anything you send or decide, whether or not an AI tool helped to write it. Check figures, names and dates before anything goes to a customer.

5.4 Asking for a new tool

To ask for a new AI tool or any other software, complete form IT-7 on the IT Service Desk portal. Requests are reviewed by the Head of IT and the Data Protection Lead, and you will get a decision within 10 working days.

6. Email and phishing

6.1 Reporting suspicious emails

If an email looks odd, for example an unexpected invoice, a delivery problem you know nothing about or an urgent request for a password, do not click links or open attachments. Use the **Report** button in the email toolbar. This sends it to the IT team and removes it from your inbox. Do not forward suspicious emails to colleagues to ask their opinion.

6.2 If you clicked a link

If you clicked a link, opened an attachment or typed your password into a page and then had doubts, phone the IT Service Desk on ext. 300 immediately. Do not just send an email. The sooner we know, the sooner we can reset your password and check your account. Nobody will be blamed for reporting a mistake quickly.

6.3 Requests to change payment details

Fraudsters often pretend to be a supplier or customer asking us to change bank details. Any request to change payment details must be checked by phoning the company on a number we already hold,

never a number given in the email. Finance will only make the change after a second person has checked it.

6.4 Phishing tests

The IT team sends practice phishing emails every quarter. If you click one, you will be asked to complete a short online refresher within 14 days. The results are used to improve our guidance and not for disciplinary action.

7. USB sticks and removable media

7.1 Blocked by default

USB memory sticks, memory cards and external hard drives are blocked on company computers. Chargers, mice and keyboards are not affected.

7.2 Exceptions

If you have a genuine business need, for example loading data from a customer's weighbridge system, apply on form IT-9. If it is approved, the IT Service Desk will issue an encrypted company USB stick. Personal USB sticks will not be allowed in any circumstances.

7.3 Found devices

If you find a USB stick or memory card on site, in a vehicle or in the car park, do not plug it into anything. Hand it to the IT Service Desk or your depot office.

8. Breaking this policy

Deliberately breaking this policy, such as sharing your password, turning off security settings or sending customer data to a personal account, may lead to disciplinary action under HR-01. Honest mistakes that are reported quickly will be treated as a chance to learn, not to punish.